



Department of Economics
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November 23, 2025

Hiring Committee
Stout
1660 International Drive, Suite 600
McLean, VA 22102

Dear Hiring Committee,

I am writing to express my interest in the PhD Economist position in Stout's Commercial Litigation – Disputes, Claims & Investigations practice. I am a Ph.D. candidate in the Department of Economics at Johns Hopkins University (advisors: Christopher D. Carroll, Nicholas W. Papageorge, and Stelios Fourakis), and I expect to receive my degree in May 2026. My primary specializations are macroeconomic modeling, wealth and income dynamics, and computational economics.

My research agenda focuses on the ability of macroeconomic models to generate empirically realistic distributions of wealth and income over the life cycle. A key driver of that work is modeling heterogeneity in the rate of return on assets, and understanding how return dispersion contributes to portfolio accumulation across households. These themes align with Stout's emphasis on rigorous quantitative analysis, financial modeling, and the use of economic theory and empirical methods to support expert testimony in litigation, damages estimation, and investigation matters.

In my job-market paper, I calibrate a life-cycle heterogeneous-agent model to match wealth moments from the Survey of Consumer Finances by allowing households to differ in their portfolio returns. The model helps explain observed wealth concentration and return dispersion. In a related research project using the Health and Retirement Study, I examine how trust influences both income growth and asset returns—finding a hump-shaped relationship for returns and characterizing the distribution of the persistent component of returns to net worth. These experiences have equipped me to: (i) frame research strategies and design modeling approaches; (ii) execute econometric and simulation analysis with large micro-data sets; and (iii) translate results into clear, rigorous written deliverables for both academic and practitioner audiences.

I am particularly drawn to Stout's work at the intersection of economics, finance, and law—especially its leadership in providing expert analysis related to commercial damages, valuation disputes, lost profits, market behavior, and fraud or investigation matters. My quantitative toolkit (Python, Stata), experience working with complex datasets, and background in constructing and validating economic and simulation-based models position me well to support analyses related to liability, causation, commercial harm, and forensic economic evaluation. I am also motivated by Stout's collaborative environment and its reputation for delivering clear, defensible expert work in high-stakes contexts.

I believe I would be a strong fit at Stout because:

1. My experience with simulation-based modeling, structural estimation, and empirical validation aligns directly with the economic and financial modeling required in litigation and damages

analyses.

2. My research on heterogeneity in returns, portfolio accumulation, and wealth dynamics translates well to work involving market behavior, financial performance, and the economic impacts of disputed conduct.
3. I bring strong communication skills and a collaborative mindset—both essential in producing expert reports, supporting testimony, and working effectively in multidisciplinary consulting teams.

I would welcome the opportunity to contribute my analytical rigor, empirical modeling experience, and commitment to high-quality economic analysis to Stout's Commercial Litigation practice. Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

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